

CAREER PATHS

Without a relevant degree, it may be possible to enter the textile industry as a pattern cutter, creating fabric templates from drawings, or as a machinist, making garment samples. On-the-job training could lead to higher qualifications.

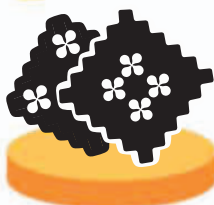
MACHINIST OR PATTERN CUTTER You can study for a vocational qualification while working as a machinist or pattern cutter, which will give you valuable experience of the textile industry.



GRADUATE Earning a degree in textile design, fashion, or a related subject can help you develop the skills, creative confidence, and industry contacts to progress as a designer.



TEXTILE DESIGNER Once qualified, you may work with fashion houses, architects, interior designers, or fabric manufacturers and retailers. You can specialize in areas such as interiors—upholstery, furnishings, and carpets—or technical fabrics, such as those used in fireproof clothing.



WALLPAPER DESIGNER
Creates patterns and textures for wallpapers and other wall coverings. Most opportunities in this specialty field are freelance, or in working for textile or wall-covering manufacturers.



FASHION DESIGNER
Designs accessories, shoes, or clothes—for mass-production or limited editions for niche markets—that mimic current trends in fabric, color, and shape, or create a new style.



INTERIOR DESIGNER
Uses a knowledge of pattern, color, texture, and design techniques to produce interior schemes—which may include textile elements—for interior design studios and architectural firms.



TEXTILE CONSERVATOR Works with museums, heritage organizations, and in the antiques trade to restore valuable textiles, such as tapestries, clothing, and wall and floor coverings. This job requires a thorough knowledge of design history, textile structure, and traditional manufacturing methods.

SKILLS GUIDE



Strong communication skills for liaising with customers, colleagues, and technical and marketing staff.



The ability to evaluate the properties of materials used in specialty and industrial textiles.



Creative flair for experimenting with different designs, materials, colors, textures, and weights.



Good computer skills and knowledge of Computer-aided Design (CAD) software.



Commercial awareness and good business sense, especially if working as a freelance designer.